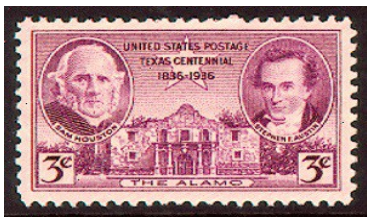
VOL 122 #6 NOVEMBER - DECEMBER 2017

THE OFFICIAL PUBLICATION OF THE SAN ANTONIO PHILATELIC ASSOCIATION FOUNDED 1896

The PHILATEX

A.P.S. Ch. # 53-0388

T.P.A. Life Ch. # 3



http://www.sastamps.org/

MEETING CALENDAR

SEPTEMBER			OCTOBER		
3	Juniors Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:30 pm	1	BLUE CHIP AUCTION	7:30 pm
4	Sat. Boursette & Library Day, Bldg #6 - Buy, sell, trade, and talk stamps ;-)	9:30 am	2	Sat. Boursette & Library Day, Bldg #6 - Buy, sell, trade, and talk stamps ;-)	9:30 am
10	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after	7:30 pm	8	Christmas Party & Election of Officers in the Fireside Room	6:00 pm
17	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:30 pm	15	NO MEETINGS -	
24	NO MEETING – HAPPY THANKSGIVING		22 29	Merry Christmas & Happy New Year	2018

January 05-Show & Tell; 06-Sat. Boursette; 12-Auction; 19-Program; 26-Bourse

This is a preview of the Dues Letter

Editor's Corner

coming your way soon!

Lea Senghaas, Ed.

SAN ANTONIO PHILATELIC ASSOC. OFFICIAL DUES LETTER FOR 2017

DUES HAVE INCREASED. THE AMOUNT OF RETURNING MEMBER IS $20.00. THE AMOUNT FOR NEW MEMBERSHIP IS $25.00. THE PRICE FOR DELINQUENT CURRENT MEMBERS IS $25.00.

PLEASE MAKE YOUR DUES PAYMENTS AS USUAL OUT TO SAPA, BUT SEND THEM TO ME, DORA L ROBERTS, 6918 SUNRIVER DR., SAN ANTONIO, TX 78244-1850.

YOU MAY PAY YOUR DUES AS EARLY AS NOVEMBER 18TH TO GET IT IN EARLY. THE EARLIER THE BETTER TO GIVE ME PLENTY OF TIME TO COMPLETE MY PAPERWORK AND PRINT ROSTERS BEFORE YEAR'S END.

PLEASE DO NOT GIVE YOUR DUES OR SEND THEM TO ANYONE BUT ME. i NEED TO POST THEM TO MY ROSTERS, AND THEN I GIVE THEM TO FRED. THE ONLY TIME I WON'T BE AT CLUB IS FOOTBALL NIGHT, AND THEY ARE DONE BY THE TIME I NEED. yOU KNOW WHO YOU ARE. PLEASE GIVE THEM ONLY TO ME.

THANK YOU FOR YOUR CONTINUED SUPPORT IN OUR CLUB.

Dora Roberts, Membership Chair

PHILATEX: Editors Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts
Labels Fred Groth
Mailing Jack Virta

The PHILATEX is published every two months and the cut off date is the 2nd Friday of the month prior to publication.

Mail your contributions for the Philatex to:
Philatex Editors
334 Olney Dr.
San Antonio, Tx 78209
Or email either of us.
lys@satx.rr.com dora.roberts@hotmail.com

Write to S.A.P.A. at:
San Antonio Philatelic Association
MacArthur Park Lutheran Church
2903 Nacogdoches Rd.
San Antonio, TX 78217

S.A.P.A. meets at the church every Friday night at 7:30 P.M. in building 1, facing Nacogdoches Rd.
Yearly dues are $20.00, prorated.

ELECTED OFFICERS:

President:	Dr. Eric Shepherd
Vice President:	Chip Swinney
Secretary:	Pat Richmond
Treasurer:	Fred Groth
Membership Chair:	Dora Roberts
Communications Chair:	George Garten
Historian:	Fred Groth
Auctioneer:	Jack Virta
Assistant Auctioneers:	Chip Swinney
	Jim Wallace
Librarian:	Debbie Osuna

BOARD OF GOVERNORS:

Board President:	Dr. Eric Shepherd
All Elected Officers:	(see above)
Past President:	John Clay
One year term:	Larry Lamborn
Two year term:	Nancy Mabie
Parliamentarian:	Harry Greer
Honorary Board Member	Bob Joyce

APPOINTED:

Auditing Committee:	Tony Bir (Chairman)

LIAISON CONTACT PERSONS:

American Philatelic Society:	Fred Groth
Austin-Texas Stamp Club:	Lyle Boardman
Eire Philatelic Association:	Patrick J. Ryan
Texas Philatelic Association:	Dr. Eric Shepherd
APS Circuit Books	Dr. Eric Shepherd

WE WELCOME VISITORS

SAPA is always happy to welcome visitors. We hope you will enjoy our activities and wish to join us as members.

All visitors are welcome to purchase stamps at our auctions, bourses and bag nights. Anyone wishing to sell or trade at our meetings must be a member.

AUCTION ETIQUETTE :

Be sure to get your Bidder's number card before the auction starts. Come early and look over the lots for sale before the auction. During the auction, lots will be identified by their lot number and a brief description of the lot.

When bidding for a lot, please raise your Bidder's Number card and keep it up until you no longer wish to bid. Flipping the card up and down is confusing for the auctioneers.

Please keep extraneous conversation to a minimum. This makes it easier for everyone to hear what the auctioneer is selling, and allows the auctioneer to more easily keep track of the bidding.

While your purchases will be given to you during the auction, please wait until the end of the auction to pay for them. Your name will be called as the tallys are completed. Those who are only buying will be called first. Buyers who are also sellers will be called next. Checks made out to S.A.P.A. are acceptable. Sellers with unsold lots should be sure to pick up their lots before leaving.

Please be sure to return the Bidder's Number cards so that we can use them again in the following auctions.

We look forward to meeting you.

President's Message

I'm sorry that I have been unable to attend any of the October meetings, but I have been involved with several shows for some of the other clubs I belong to. The first week of October, I helped with the postcard show put on by the Capital of Texas Postcard Club. I took best in show for a frame I entered of postcards showing the famous Flat Iron Building in New York City. I also purchased about 300 cards for my collection, which I am now putting into my database. This last weekend, I was in charge of the Orchid Show at the SA Garden Center put on by the Alamo Orchid Society. I am happy to report it was a very succeful show. I was also able to buy several good orchid plants for my collection. This coming weekend I will be in Fredericksburg for get together of the River City Villagers. On November 4th, the San Antonio Shell Club will have their annual auction of seashells. In addition to all of these activities, I am working on all of my stamp collections and going to estate sales. I love being retired.

Dr. Eric Shepherd *November 2017*

Treasurer's Message

The club earned $838.58 from sales and donations from our fellow members and guests at our special auction on Oct, 13, 2017. A big thank you to all who participated.

Fred Groth, **Treasurer**

UPCOMING
SHOWS & BOURSES

NOV 3-4 TSDA HOUSTON STAMP SHOW Crown Plaza Hotel, 7611 Katy Freeway (IH-10 West), Houston, TX 77024. **Hours: Friday 10am-5pm, Saturday 9am-4pm.**

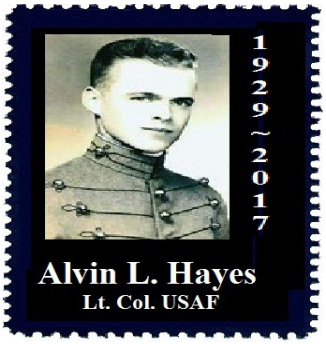
NOV 10-11 MID-CITIES STAMP CLUB EXPO Grapevine Convention Center, 1209 Main St, Grapevine, Tx 76051. (Highway 114 at Main St. exit, just north of DFW Airport.) **Hours: Friday 11am-5pm, Saturday 9am-4pm**

DEC 8-9 TSDA DALLAS STAMP SHOW Richardson Civic Center, 411 W. Arapaho Rd, Richardson, TX 75080-4551. **Hours: Friday 11am-5pm, Saturday 9am-4pm.**

Welcome New Members

Bob Bettis #2851
collects all US, including Back of Book.

Kathy Beer #2852
collects postcards & Federal Duck stamps.



CLOSED ALBUMS

Alvin L. Hayes, SAPA # 2640, joined in 1996. He collected Ireland, Canada, Hong Kong, and Treaty Ports. He passed away on July 25, 2017, and will be missed by all who knew him.

HOW THE AUCTION WILL WORK:

Items will be on display at club meetings November 3rd & 17th.

PLEASE LOOK ONLY, DO NOT TOUCH.
Ask Jack for help if you need to see an item more closely.

If you have any questions, call 210-826-4826, or come to the meetings. To bid: write the lot #, the maximum amount you wish to bid, your name, address, phone, and email (if you have one), and mail your bid to: SAPA - Jack Virta
2907 Sir Phillip
San Antonio, Tx 78209
You will be notified if you win a lot. If you wish to have it mailed to you, it will be sent upon receipt of payment (includes amount of bid, tax, plus postage and insurance). If you wish to make other arrangements to pick-up your purchases, contact Jack Virta at the above address / phone number.

ABBREVIATIONS

Av = Average (perf touches design)
AF = Almost Fine
F = Fine (perfs clear design)
VF = Very Fine (nicely centered)
S = Superb centering
MNH = Mint Never Hinged
MHR = Mint Hinge Remnant
MLH = Mint Light Hinge
MVLH = Mint Very Light Hinge
NG = No Gum
OG = Original Gum
est = estimated price
LC = Light Cancel
MC = Medium Cancel
HC = Heavy Cancel
SS = Souvenir Sheet

BIDDING & CAT

Bidding increments go up as follows:
$5 - $15 = 50¢
$15 - $50 = $1
$50 - up = $5

CATALOGS
Scott 2017, Vs. 1-6
Scott 2017, Specialized

otherwise, our best estimate

Avoiding Forgeries: Security Measures on Stamps

by Lea Senghaas Aug 18, 2017

Ever since the invention of the stamp, people have been trying to find ways to not pay for postage. The Post Offices don't like this–it costs them money. But how do they try to keep people from ripping them off?

This is a brief coverage of what I have learned about the subject of security for stamps, and a bit of the history of counterfeits, forgeries, and fakes.

Counterfeits are produced in large quantities, and sold at lower prices than legitimate postage. This makes the most common current stamp used for everyday mailing a prime target for counterfeiting activity. They are sold to small vendors, and on the internet. In the above picture, the stamp on the right is counterfeit. As of 2010, the Post Office is loosing over 130 million dollars to counterfeiting and other postal frauds.

Forgery refers to a stamp created to fool philatelists into thinking that it is a genuine one.The earliest forgeries are all postal, and the *Penny Black* was the first stamp to be copied in 1840, its first year.--> Partial forgery consists of changing colors or changing the face values of stamps to imitate a higher value stamp. Other tricks consisted of methods to make the cancellation disappear (chemically erasing, placing a second stamp on it if it just hits a corner).

Fakes begin with a genuine stamp, which is altered in some way to make it more valuable to stamp collectors. When catalogues show different varieties with significantly different values this can be great motivation to alter the cheap example into something that can be sold for great profit. Sometimes only <--minor changes can affect the apparent valuation of a stamp, like this faked 1919 overprint.

Here are some of the things the Post Office does or has done: Watermarks, Microprinting, Anti-Stokes, Infraredesign, Scrambled Indicia, Security Perforations, and Security Papers.

Watermarks - A watermark is an identifying image or pattern in paper that appears as various shades of lightness/darkness when viewed by transmitted light, caused by thickness or density variations in the paper. They vary greatly in their visibility. They can have multiple or Single marks on each stamp.

Microprinting - Microprinting is an anti-counterfeiting technique principally used on banknotes and involves printing a lowercase text, placed in an inconspicuous location, in lettering too small to be read with the naked eye. It is very difficult to reproduce accurately when you try to disguise the object on which it is printed: when the stamp is placed in a copier or a scanner, a line of microprinting text is read just as a dotted line. Another form of microprinting (common in Ukraine and USA) is to include the designer's name, the year of issue or the printing company's acronym hidden somewhere on the stamp.

Scrambled Indicia - Since 1997 to 2004 the United States P.O. issued several stamps that contain an anti-counterfeiting "hidden image" with a technique called Scrambled Indicia ®. The images magically appear only through a special device called the "Stamp Decoder™", held at the correct angle.

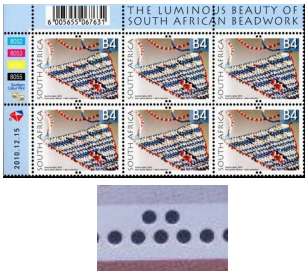
Anti-Stokes - The security feature called "Anti-Stokes" consists of a special pigment which completes the offset printing process. With this technique the stamp (subject to special monitoring tools) emits green light under infrared light HORUS 1019 and beeps when it is inspected by the RADIR 2029 device.->

Infraredesign - INFRAREDESIGN® is an unique system derived from the same scientific basis of metamerism, but it make use of the normal processes of color printing. The phenomenon called metamerism occurs when the colors that look identical under a certain light, show different shades when submit to a different light. In 1970, a family of Croatian scientists began to study the response of colors, normally visible to the human eye, when exposed to infrared light. These studies have led to the discovery a new frontier in anti-counterfeiting: the added protection of a spectrum of colors in an image or text can be seen only under infrared light and can not be photocopied or scanned.

Security perforations

Elliptical syncopations

Other syncopated patterns



Shaped syncopations

Die-cutting (self-adhesives)

Serpentine perforations

Security techniques against reuse

To prevent re-use the United States p.o. impressed on stamps an embossed "grill " with a small waffle iron that broke the paper fibers, thus would absorb the ink cancellation, avoiding re-use. In practice the grills weakened the stamps, making them prone to tearing.

Crossed slashes through dove are to prevent removal and reuse of the stamp.-->

Die cuts are semi-circular slits designed to inhibit the removal of these stamps <-- for fraudulent re-use.

Security papers - To prevent reuse of stamps or forgery, in addition to use of watermarks, were used different varieties of paper. Here we list some. Certain postage stamps have been printed on security paper, which is paper that has additional characteristics coated or printed onto the paper to prevent the reuse of the postage stamp and as a means to prevent forgery.

Burelage, also burelé, is a French term meaning an intricate network of fine dots, lines, or other designs printed over or as the background of some postage or revenue stamps to prevent counterfeiting. ----->

goldbeater's skin is a parchment, made of the outer membrane of calf's intestine, which is traditionally used in the process of reducing gold into mere 1µm-thick leaves. The skin is thin, elastic and doesn't tear under heavy goldbeating. A pack of 1,000 pieces of goldbeater's skin is only 1 inch thick. In Prussia, in1866, the North German Confederation printed 10-

<--and 30-groschen postage stamps on goldbeater's skin, to prevent reuse of these high-value stamps. The stamp design was stamped in reverse at the back and the glue was applied over. When the stamp was affixed to the letter, the stamp design appeared through the card correctly.

Double paper is a paper composed of a thin surface layer and a thicker backing layer used in the printing of postage stamps especially to prevent removal of cancellation marks US 1873 - 2, 3¢ -->

Chalky paper is a type of safety paper that was designed to cause the stamp's design to rub off or smear when an attempt was made to remove the cancellation on the stamp. The paper was coated with a solution containing a suspension of chalk. The British government used chalky paper in many of its colonies. One destructive test of chalk paper is to rub a piece of silver on the paper. A black, pencil-like mark will result if the paper is chalky.

Examples of different security paper used on postage stamps. - Burelage

Lilac network of Estonia's 1928–35 10s stamp

Gray network of Danzig's 1922 6m stamp

Blue Winchester security paper of Venezuela's 1932–38 25c stamp

Security paper of Venezuela's 1952 1b security stamp

Colored dots on El Salvador's 1907 1c stamp

Here are some of the websites I have found useful information about my topic, and there are lots of other philatelic goodies on these sites. I highly recommend them to you.

http://stampsjoann.net/ https://www.mysticstamp.com/info/what-is-microprinting-2/
http://www.linns.com https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Philately
https://www.apfelbauminc.com/library/the-history-of-stamp-counterfeiting-and-how-to-spot-a-fake
http://postalmuseumblog.si.edu/2011/03/innovations-in-us-postage-stamp-security-mircroprinting-part-1.html

This was an interesting program for me to put on, and I hope it was informative for everyone who attended it. If anyone has any questions for me about it, please email me at lys@satx.rr.com, subject SAPA program.

Yours in Philately, Lea Senghaas

Inaugural Donation Auction October 13, 2017

Jack Virta and Chip Swinney held court over the first ever Donation Auction for the San Antonio Philatelic Association. The auction was very well attended. The items were as varied as they could be. We had coins, stamps on paper, stamps off paper, catalogues, Halloween candy and even a beautiful pitcher and bowl for cleaning your hands and face afterwards. If you were not there, you missed a very gala occasion. We even had plants and mystery containers that had a collection of goodies. If you missed this first auction, you missed a ton of fun!!! ***Yours in Philately,***

Pat Richmond

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CHRISTMAS 2017